



Crucible Education Centre
General Paper
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GENERAL PAPER: GLOBALISATION INFOPACK



Crucible Education Centre



General concepts in globalisation

Globalisation is the standardisation of norms globally.

- Globalization is the process of international integration arising from the interchange of world views, products, ideas and other aspects of culture.
- With a more interconnected world, there arises more conflict and issues brought about by the mingling of different people and ideas
- On the other hands, greater interconnectedness means that we can work together to solve problems more coherently
- With globalization, aspects of a nation such as the relevance of national borders and unique culture are challenged
- People are exposed to new ideologies and crave for greater freedom in the increasingly liberal and democratic world. This creates more opportunities but also creates more conflict between the government and the masses.
- Immigration becomes a prominent issues as people struggle with the costs and the problems of assimilation and integration

Globalisation depends on the following for it to be positive/beneficial

1. Human goodwill / altruism of countries

- a. But possible complication: Selfish interests of some parties
 - i. Globalisation can become a force of evil
 - ii. E.g: Criminal networks increasingly connected around the globe

2. Cooperation and collaboration

- a. But possible complication: Inbuilt tensions and antagonism + competing interests of countries

3. Common interests, values (Harmony, peace, compassion, upright, law and order)



- a. Positive outcomes: World and societal progress + increase in diversity in religion and culture with greater harmony and peace with coexistence
- b. But possible complication: Subversive and violent ideals
 - i. Terrorists and extremist movements
 - ii. Negative outcomes: World and societal regression
 - iii. E.g: ISIS monocultural aims to destroy other religions



Forms of Globalisation

1. Political globalisation

Refers to Institutions, norms that have been affected by globalisation.

- Democratisation of countries
- greater human progress

o E.g: Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB)

- Can be negative = increase in terrorist movements across the globe
- Traditional notions of self and political identity are rapidly challenged and replaced by more resilient notions that advocate common global values and a love for a wider humanity
- Past: Preoccupations with nationalism and the need to expend their energies and resources on raising the status and power of individual nations over others
- Present: Social entrepreneurs and visionaries united together in a common mission of service to humanity

We have morphed into a species previously driven by the divisive fear of others to one that rejoices in and celebrates our collective successes in alleviating global challenges

- Globalisation has enabled widespread travel; including influxes of refugee boat people fleeing from war-torn and economically impoverished countries
- Failure of globalisation's promises: A world united by visions of brotherhood and harmony and shared values have imploded under the weight of its own unrealistic aspirations of a more common world
- E.g: Australian boat people: More than 18000 people arrived in Australia illegally by sea from 2012 to 2013, mainly from Afghanistan, Sri Lanka, or Myanmar. Hundreds have died making the dangerous journey.



- Most of them are asylum seekers, and the Australian government introduced the Nauru and Papua New Guinea (PNG) policy as temporary detention camps for asylum seekers □ The living conditions in PNG and Nauru camps are very inadequate, causing physical and mental health issues in detainees
- The government also introduced controversial temporary visas for the refugees, allowing them to work in Australia for 3-5 years but denying their permanent protection
- The government also utilised the 'tow-back' policy in which many asylum seekers at sea were intercepted and returned to their countries □ sending them back to the country where they will be persecuted + Australia criticised to have failed to meet its international obligations by sending refugees back to impoverished nations ill-equipped to handle them □ potential inadequate protections

2. Economic globalisation

Refers to the increase in TNCs, capital flows, liquidity of labour, markets due to globalisation.

- Increase in integration and interconnectedness of global economy
- Positive multiplier effect for trade and economic activities
- Increase in advancement and globalisation of technology and transport connectivity
- But increase in the risk of crash of stock markets between dependent countries (vulnerable)
- E.g: US-China markets
- ISIS: Increase in attacks and fear of stock markets
- E.g: Uber threaten local jobs (mainly taxi-drivers) and can be means of crimes in the community (security risks of globalisation)



- Globalisation today expands our networks with complex interconnections of ties, interactions, and resources being bases for economic and scientific progress
- High levels of trade activities, businesses work round the clock, and an increase of choices and consumption by people worldwide
- Economic globalisation implosion: Inequality; Globalisation only served to enrich a small minority that was fortunate and skilled enough to capitalise on the opportunities made available by the explosion in global trade and technology from 1990s onwards
- The arrival of the Internet has provided the new generation of digitally savvy technopreneurs the means to make products and services demanded by consumers worldwide

- However, in reality, there is the existence of the corporate social responsibility and “give-back” movement in which many entrepreneurs who have become rich due to globalisation have taken part in philanthropic movements to give back their accumulated wealth to those who need them

- E.g: Warren Buffet, Donald Trump, Mark Zuckerberg, Bill Gates, and most of them have an obligation to donate

- Globalisation implosion: Injustice and degradation of human rights + increase in opportunity for exploitation of social and human rights
- Globalisation can bring out the worst in human nature, incentivising those with power to use it in oppressing their fellow human beings and illegally taking from the weak their material possessions, dignity, and even their right to life
- E.g: Petty officials in China forcefully evict poor farmers from their land and sold them to developers who are eager to attract foreign investments

- “Crowding-out” effect: Global cities wish to position themselves well in the globalised world to attract rich investors to buy lands in the city: London has one of the highest land process in which Middle Eastern rich buyers purchase



the land that the middle income locals cannot afford □ Cost of living for the middle and low income locals decreases

- Global demand for cheap retail clothing has incentivised local contractors in Bangladesh's textile industry to deceive their employees to work in poor-paying jobs in industries with working conditions □ Exploitation of cheap labour to maximise their profit in this globalised world

3. Technological globalisation

- Exponential improvements in technology due to popular demand by globalisation (technology is a crucial enabling tool for globalisation)
- Public perceptions for the basis of increase in quality of life
- Containerisation, increase in health/services, transport technologies, communication
- Increase in collaborations for developments of technology
- Propel positive change for increase in quality of life and decrease in income disparity
- Networked society (big data and the internet of things)
- Smart cities □ infusion of technology and information into urban life
- Exponential growth of information = increase in power and money
- Increase in technological systems = increase in convenience and sustainability
- Expanding networks enabled us to elevate our quality of life and prosperity to high levels
- E.g: Human Genome Project involves the collaboration of scientists with talents diversified among the different countries, completed in 2003
- data now are routinely available to all scientists worldwide to pioneer the next innovation
- However, there is an increasing innocuous trend of indolence among citizens
- Technological disruptions of daily life



- Generation Y youth are more self-indulgent than before with today's age of new media and internet
- Young people are more obsessed over online games and social networking sites than real world problems like energy crisis, global hunger, and human rights abuses □ A culture of self-gratification, self-promotion, and self-indulgence

4. Cultural globalisation

- Globalisation informs the masses and the societies of cultural changes
- Homogenisation of cultures vs Nationalism
- Identity, behaviour, values, perceptions
- Soft power of countries
- Increase in positive friendly perception of the country □ marketing to other countries so as to increase investment opportunities and collaboration between countries vs going into conflicts
- Increase in the free expression of religions and practices



Theme 1: Globalisation and Culture

General arguments:

1. The homogenizing influences of globalization promote integration and the removal not only of cultural barriers but of many of the negative dimensions of culture
 - a. Globalization is a vital step toward both a more stable world and better lives for people
2. However, homogenisation is often condemned by the new nationalists and by cultural romanticists
 - a. Many societies, particularly indigenous peoples, view culture as their richest heritage, without which they have no roots, history or soul.
 - b. Its value is other than monetary. To commodify it is to destroy it.

A. Influence of US corporations on local customs

“Americanisation” of world cultures and the dominance of the American Market

- a. Reasons for their dominance:
 - i. Large size of US market (nearly 300 million consumers)
 - ii. Large wealth of US economy (nearly 25% of global economic output)
 - iii. Comparatively homogeneous culture (97% of population fluent in English language)

B. Integration of Cultures

Many cultures have contributed to global culture, including American culture itself. Just like how American popular culture influences foreign countries, other national cultures are influential within the United States and also increase their presence worldwide.

- E.g: Hollywood is a good example of an industry that integrates elements from more than one culture; while Hollywood dominates world cinema, American movies are subjected to foreign influence
 - o Many American movies are remakes of foreign films: “The Departed”, 2007 Academy Award Winner for Best Picture, is a remake of the Chinese successful film “Infernal Affairs”
 - o James Cameron, producer of the movie “Titanic” is Canadian



□ While Hollywood may incorporate many foreign elements into its craft, its public face is still distinctly American

C. Reaffirmation of Local Culture

□ E.g: India satellite TV permits an increase in number of regional channels that telecast Indian content □ gives Indian individual new opportunities to identify with his regional ties

□ The homogenising effects of globalisation on national cultures may in fact tends to produce a reaction among indigenous people □ influencing them to want to reaffirm their own local cultures and traditions

o E.g: Capitalism favours a more fast-paced environment and a consumer culture which differ from the lifestyle that people in some countries are used to □ This is particularly hard to accept for people who are afraid of change and want to preserve their own

D. Cultural Impacts of Globalisation

1. New global professions

a. Increased volumes of immigration and mobility + multiculturalism + problems of diversity and tolerance of different races and ethnicities

2. Pop culture

a. Many complain that this form of globalisation is actually Americanisation because United States is the largest producer of popular culture goods

b. Growth of influence of American television and film industries

The Canadian Magazine Dispute

□ 89% of magazines sold in Canada are foreign, with high percentage from America
□ Despite a low proportion of domestically produced magazines in Canada, the Canadian government still has nonetheless identified the production of magazines as an important touchstone of the Canadian national identity

□ Attempts to protect the Canadian culture from domination: 1920s – imposed protective tariffs on foreign magazines □ Absolute prohibition was easily applied and enforced at the port of entry



- o However, globalisation has recently changed this: Advances in technology have blurred the line between foreign and domestic and trade agreements have limited the options that governments may choose in giving preferential treatment to domestic goods
- o E.g: Time Warner was able to print “Sports Illustrated Canada” electronically via satellite printers in Canada without having it being stopped at the border
- o Because these American-originating magazines serve a much larger market, they are able to take advantage of the principle of economy of scale, and to offer lower advertising prices. It was predicted that the diversion of advertising revenue would force many Canadian periodicals out of business.

Globalisation vs Asian Values

- Some government officials in East Asian nations have boldly proclaimed an alternative to the Western cultural model by declaring an adherence to the traditional Asian values
- Asian values are typically described as embodying the Confucian ideals of respect for authority, hard work, thrift, and the belief that the community is more important than the individual. This is said to be coupled with a preference for economic, social, and cultural rights rather than political rights.
- The most frequent criticism of these values is that they run contrary to the universality of human rights and tend to condone undemocratic undercurrents in some countries, including the suppression of dissidents, and the excessive use of national security laws.
- Singapore's former leader Lee Kwan Yew has used the term to justify the extremely well-ordered society Singapore maintains, and its laissez-faire economic approach. His theories are often referred to as the "Lee Thesis," which claims that political freedoms and rights can actually hamper economic growth and development. According to this notion, order as well as personal and social discipline, rather than political liberty and freedom, are most appropriate for Asian societies. Adherents to this view claim that political freedoms, liberties, and democracy are Western concepts, foreign to their traditions.
- Other critics have more strident criticisms against the use of the Asian values argument. They argue that these supposed values have stymied independent



thinking and creativity and fostered authoritarian regimes. According to this view, Asian values were partly responsible for the corruption that affected so many nations in the region, making the press and people reluctant to criticize their governments.

Western Values and Islam

- Globalization is accelerating some people's concerns about the infusions of Western values in Islamic countries.
- In the 1960s, the Shah of Iran sought rapid modernization--regardless of conservative Muslim opinion. His plan called for land reform designed to aid the poor, the extension of voting rights to women, and the allowance of the formation of political parties. His plan, along with other social and economic changes, led to increased resentment and hostility toward the Shah. Rightly or wrongly, reform efforts became symbolic of what was wrong with Iranian society. Fundamentalist clerics began to rail against Iran's "westoxification," and brought about a radical revolutionary movement that sought to expel all western influence from their ancient civilization.
- The clash between Western values and Islam culture reached an all-time high on September 11, 2001 with the terrorist attack on the World Trade Center in New York City. The event widened the chasm between the cultures, exemplified by anti-America riots in several Islamic countries, or the post 9-11 'anti-Muslim backlash' in the United States.
- During the recent Arab Spring, western cultural values were used to achieve popular political goals in the Middle East. Western cultural staples such as social networking tools like Facebook and Twitter were essential to the organization of recent uprisings in the Middle East. According to The National, "nearly 9 in 10 Egyptians and Tunisians surveyed in 2011 said they were using Facebook to organise protests or spread awareness about them" And almost all of these protests came to fruition, inciting popular political action through westernized means.

Protecting Languages

- France has attracted the most notoriety for attempting to protect its language from the immigration of foreign words; the government decided to replace the word "hashtag" which is used frequently in Twitter and other social media, with the Gallic word "mot-dièse"



- China: Authorities in China recently scrutinized the brands and names of over 20,000 western companies, forcing them to change 2,000 to more Chinese-sounding names.
- This movement demonstrates the extreme sensitivity of cultural issues, and the visceral reaction that many people have to what they perceive to be threats to their traditional ways of life.



Theme 2: Globalisation and Technology

Advances in Information Technology

- Moore's law: The amount of power in a processor doubles approximately every two years
- Rapid advancements in fiber optic technologies have also been critical to the IT revolution: allowing data to be captured in digital form to be transmitted at speed of light through telecommunication cables

Impacts of Information Technology on Societal Sectors

- By improving access to health care, education, and government services to these sectors, new IT has the potential to help people around the world overcome geographic or income barriers which currently degraded the quality of their lives.
- By dramatically increasing access information, the advances can enhance knowledge, break down barriers to participation, and improve the accountability of public and private institutions to its people.

□ **Health care**

- o Efforts to contain outbreaks of dangerous infectious diseases require the rapid collection and transmission of detailed patient data to medical labs or public health centers. Health professionals need tools to communicate important scientific or epidemiological findings to other parts of the health care community. IT is enhancing capacity in each of these areas.
- o Digital records and images utilizing digital cameras have made it possible for doctors around the world to share information or offer advice on treatments for complicated ailments.
- o E.g: Using Internet connections, doctors working in remote regions of northern Uganda during an outbreak of the deadly Ebola virus would be able rapidly to transmit their findings to experts at the World Health Organization in Geneva and the U.S. Centers for Disease Control in Atlanta.
- o IT systems have had a profound effect on the healthcare system in the U.S. as well as other systems around the world wherein new technologies are utilized in an effort to efficiently providing healthcare to a large audience. New initiatives are being



undertaken by governments in a multilateral effort to provide for patients that are not within accessible reach of a hospital.

- o E.g: John's Hopkins University is providing individuals with mobile technology to seek advice or treatment from a doctor that is unattainable due to a lack of resources.

□ **Education**

- o IT improves educational opportunities by enabling educators and students to overcome barriers of distance and by enhancing the content of instructional materials.

- o Most colleges and universities across the United States offer some online course offerings. In 2012, the latest development is the rise of Coursera, which offers free online courses from elite universities, such as MIT and Harvard, reaching more than one million registered students in 2012.

- o The Internet provides an extraordinary opportunity for students to extend the reach of their learning. Before the Internet, the resources available to students were largely those that could be found in their

classrooms, in their outdated textbooks or in public libraries. The Internet enables students to reach well beyond the physical confines of their classrooms and gain access to virtually unlimited quantities of information on the topics or events they are discussing in their classrooms.

- o IT offers especially valuable educational opportunities for poor people in developing countries. Students and other residents of poor countries are increasingly using the Internet—often in community Internet centers

- o Countries such as Norway and New Zealand have implemented classroom programs into their classrooms that help students become proficient in 'digital literacy' and 'media literacy' in the globalized world.

□ **Journalism and Media**

- o The technological revolutions of the Internet have ushered in a new age of journalism that cannot be confined to one medium or one platform of exchange. It has made publishing and accessing news easier and cheaper than ever before with more sources and varied voices.

- o The Obama campaign, utilized the internet as a communication, information and outreach platform in an unparalleled fashion. In 2012, voters used their cellphones,



particularly their smart phones, to get information about the elections or to keep up to date about political issues

- o In the 2012 U.S. Presidential Election, the debates were live-streamed using YouTube, giving greater access to the events as it allowed voters to watch it on phones and other devices. The use of the Internet as a medium became more important in the recent election as it allowed the nominees to connect with citizens who would otherwise not watch cable news

- o As of October 2012, there were an estimated 77 million Tumblr and 56.6 million WordPress blogs

- o The purpose of a blog ranges from personal use, functioning like an online diary, to political commentary and trend analyses. Web blogs are increasing in popularity due to the ease with which one can be publish material online.

- o Twitter may even be replacing blogs as it becomes a major source of news stories for millions of followers worldwide. In 2012, people sent 340 million tweets per day

o Controversies over such media revolution:

1. Crime and punishment / crime reporting via everyday user of the Internet: High school in Steubenville Ohio: Members of the football team posted pictures and tweets that suggested a rape had taken place at a large party. The pictures posted on both Twitter and Instagram quickly resulted in rape charges being filed for some of the teens, without which the information may never have come to light.

2. Some governments tightening internet restrictions further as blogging becomes more popular: Users who mention topics such as corruption, prostitution, or apostasy can possibly face a death sentence in countries such as Iran. Iran was also amongst the first countries to ban YouTube from the Iranian Internet providers

3. The media revolution is consequently hurting print media, such as newspapers and magazines; In the past six years, print ad revenue has fallen > 50%

- ☐ But less consumption of print ☐ less environmental damage

- ☐ Government

- o The use of IT in government, sometimes called “e-government,” can enhance the efficiency and effectiveness of government services. E-government can also help achieve other important goals of good governance, such as accountability and transparency.



o In democratic societies, information on government activities should be readily available for review by the public □ IT revolution as a facilitator and enhancement to the democratic process

1. Using these technologies, governments today can provide citizens with fast and free access to a wide variety of documents and records.

o IT can also provide mechanisms through which governments can interact with citizens. Information technology can also improve the performance and efficiency of government bureaucracies, and enhance interagency cooperation. In these ways, technology can strengthen the delivery of government services.

Technology in Warfare

- Radar – Any location can be detected using EM waves
- Weapons of mass destruction raised questions of morality as these technologies are unable to indiscriminate harm

Science, itself, can be evil

□ Science is thought to be morally neutral, and it is up to the society to decide how to use it. However, the ‘society’ includes the government and large corporations and they decide how scientists work

□ Science costs money, and the ‘society’ can supply money for what they want to profit

o Yury Ovchinnikov, leader of Soviet bioweapons research, "Nobody would give us money for medicine. But offer one weapon and you'll get full support."

□ *Nothing in this world is so completely good that it can't sometimes serve evil ends.*

o Soviet bioweapons research, a large waste of money, was used to produce a bacterium that causes a victim to suffer Legionnaire's disease, a huge damage to one's nervous system

□ *It is the nature of a corrupt system, like the Soviet Union communism, that corrupts the people who work within it such that ordinary men end up doing extraordinary wicked things.*



Web 2.0

□ A core aspect of Web 2.0 is harnessing collective intelligence through open source project, mass collaboration, user engagement on social networks, and rethinking the traditional business model.

□ Social Networking Sites (SNS):

o Along with a profile, another important aspect of social networking is being able to link to the circle of friends that your acquaintances have built, creating a world that is truly connected by a few clicks of a mouse.

o Social networking sites have gotten much attention recently as privacy has become an increasingly important issue as younger children begin to use these sites
o Recent study by USC revealed that the younger generation is less likely to hesitate to give out personal information on sites like Facebook.

o SNS and Law enforcement: The use of social networking has begun playing a prominent role in combating terrorism and seen by the recent Boston Bombings event. Thousands of witnesses flooded the Internet and authorities with evidence in the form of pictures and video, taken mostly from cell phones. Users of online social networking sites like Facebook and Reddit, began examining evidence that was made available by other users and started making conclusions based on it. These amateur investigations began to hurt the official one, forcing authorities to stay one step ahead of the Internet vigilantes.

□ □ The events of the Boston Bombings highlight both the benefit and the drawback of an interconnected world, with untold amounts of recording devices being used on a daily basis.

□ The use of social media will continue to be instrumental in law enforcement in the coming years, however, it also showcases its limits and how police should deal with similar events in the future.

o SNS and activism: SNSs facilitate the mobilization of grass-root movements, especially among the younger generation

□ SNSs played a significant role in the spread of the Arab Spring and revolts of early 2011. In Algeria, Tunisia and Egypt, civil unrest was spread through social media sites and protestors were given a place to organize. Due to restrictions placed on conventional media, the Internet provided a perfect platform for dissenters to voice their opinions and spread their ideals



□ President Morsi of Egypt issued his policy announcements via Facebook. In other countries such as Iran, political candidate Hooshang Amirahmadi has taken to Reddit, answering questions from all over the world.

□ Peer Production: Fortress of Collective Creativity and Mass Collaboration / Open Source

- o One of the key elements of peer production is the widespread availability of information. Projects are open to anyone who feels the desire to contribute.

- o One of the most successful open source projects: Firefox. It is a web browser managed by Mozilla whose aim is to “promote openness, innovation and opportunity on the web”. There is no hierarchy that dictates the method of production; ordinary Internet users are encouraged to give feedback and partake in the Firefox venture. Currently it is one of the most popular open source project (but facing competition from Google Chrome)

- o Because opensourced products are constantly being improved and updated, there is little reason to purchase software that only comes out once a year. For instance, OpenOffice, an OS software aiming to compete with Microsoft Office, is updated as often as every two months. On the other hand,

Microsoft Office software comes out once a year. OS projects are free-to-use and free-to-update. The 2010 Microsoft Office products range from \$150 to \$500.

- o Open source software saves organizations millions of dollars in information technology. One of the most popular uses of open source software today is in education, which allows schools that are hurt by budget cuts to move from paying for closed source tools to free open source options, such as switching to Linux, a free open source operating system, One school reported saving over \$4,000 in resourcing costs alone by switching to open source software.

- o In 2012, the Obama Administration released the “We The People” online petition application to help U.S. citizens start petitions or register their point of view. The Administration wants to support more open source initiatives and hopes this is the first of many new programs and apps. Recently, open source software has been developed for the express purpose of allowing the free flow of information from governments to people who request it.



☐ Cloud Computing

- o The basis of cloud computing is that data is not stored on a person's physical machine but hosted in third party pools known as the cloud. This allows for businesses to store more information without having to worry about failure of their own computers and risk losing vital information. This type of storage has already been adopted by Amazon, Google, and Microsoft.
- o These services also allow virtual collaboration on projects that can also be worked on simultaneously, making meetings and traditional office work obsolete. One of the key benefits to cloud storage is the ability to recover from a disaster, since the data is stored in a third party location any problems can easily be mitigated.
- o However, there have been concerns about the security of data that is stored in the cloud and whether this information could be sabotaged easily.

Concerns of the Technological Age

☐ International Digital Divide

- o Only approximately 38% of world's population uses the Internet
- o Although many individuals think globalization has led to an increase in global inequality the truth is technology has widened the gap between the rich and the poor in the world. Technology continues to adapt and grow at such an accelerated rate that most countries cannot afford the new technology innovations. The lack of resources hampers country progressions in economics, education, healthcare, and so on.

☐ Privacy and Security Concerns

- o Personal information that may be of interest to businesses or people with malevolent aims is generated whenever people surf the Internet. Companies, for example, are able to learn a great deal about web surfers who visit their websites. Using tracking devices known as "cookies," companies are able to track purchases and gather personal data.
- o They can use this information to target their marketing efforts at individual consumers or groups of consumers.
- o It will be difficult to strike a balance between protecting privacy and ensuring a flow of information and data that can enhance quality of life



- o Recent data forecasts that worldwide spending on security will hit \$86 billion in 2016 as a result of increased concern over cybercrime from China, which has been made a priority by the Obama administration.
- o Internet or computer service disruptions have become a major problem not only for companies, but for governments, associations, international institutions, and private citizens around the world.



Theme 3: Globalisation and the environment

Introduction

Increased economic integration has caused environmental problems to be a global problem

- Growing environmentalists and NGOs suggesting rigorous environmental protection regulations and international laws, but the UN environment body has not been created mainly due to the unwillingness of USA and China

- Growing debate on whether too much environmental regulation is good in the long run:

- o Environmental protection can entail a drag on economic growth in the short-term. Industries that have to adjust to environmental regulations face disruption and higher costs, harming their competitive position.

- o Some argue that it may be worth slower economic growth in order to protect the environment.

- o Others say that the free market and technological advances are the best tools to solve environmental problems and lift people out of poverty, rather than greater regulation.

- However, the link between environment and economic development is much more complex than that, in fact, many ways can prove that protecting the environment while promoting economic growth are actually complementary goals

- o *Poverty in LDCs is a leading cause for environmental degradation*

- o E.g: “Slash-and-burn” land-clearing method by subsistence farmers has been a major cause for the depletion of the Amazon rainforest □ boosting economic growth may be effective in promoting the protection of the forest

- o □ *Idea of sustainable development movement*

- 2013: 100+ students in Istanbul, Turkey, protested against an urban development project to build a mall in the city's largest green space, Gezi Park

Sustainable development

- The first major endorsement of sustainable development came at the 1992 Rio Conference which set forth the Rio Declaration on the Environment and



Development and the Agenda 21. The declaration outlined the goals of sustainable development

- States were enjoined to "cooperate to eradicate poverty" and to "cooperate in a spirit of global partnership to conserve, protect and restore the health and integrity of the Earth's ecosystem"
- *The 'differing responsibilities' of nations at different development levels were emphasised: DCs should provide scientific know-how, technology, and financial resources to poorer countries to help them develop and protect the environment*
- The idea of sustainable development has not, however, ended controversies over the relationship between economic growth and environmental protection. In fact, in many ways the World Conference on Sustainable Development in 2002, intended to review progress since the Rio Summit, demonstrated the *continuing divisions in the international community*
- *It remains to be seen whether the continuing disputes in the international community can be overcome to lead to real progress on eliminating poverty and simultaneously protecting the environment*
- More than 40 years since the 1972 Stockholm Conference, dozens of international conferences, national laws, local initiatives, government programs and non-governmental campaigns have not resolved the fundamental tensions that underlie the relationship between globalization and the environment. Instead, all these efforts have challenged countries to manage those tensions in ways that are politically feasible within their domestic political context and their financial resources. The results of this process for the environment and for human development are still unfolding.

Climate refugees

- People who must leave their homes and countries because of the effects of climate change and global warming
- Rising sea level can cause some land completely underwater, making it uninhabitable
- Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC) predicts that sea level will rise a total of 0.18 to 0.6m from 1990 to 2100, and Scientists predict that Bangladesh will lose 17% of its land by 2050 □ 20 million climate refugees from Bangladesh alone



- Island states:
 - o Mauritius, Solomon islands, Kiribati, Fiji, Tonga □ Predicted to be wiped out by rising sea level by 2050
 - o Maldives is only max 2.4m above sea level; Tourism supports > 25% of the economy
- Further sea level rise will threaten economy greatly + affects fishing industry (2nd largest industry)
- Sea level rise may sink all 1200 islands of Maldives, forcing them to evacuate
- Environmental refugees are not protected by the international laws, they face greater political risks as they can be sent back to their devastated homeland or forced into refugee camps
- These refugees have to also adjust to new environment (different laws and cultures)
- Refugees also will lead to increase in competition for resources and land with locals, thus triggering conflicts and possible wars



Theme 4: The challenges and responsibilities brought about by globalisation

The advent of globalisation has been a double-edged sword, countries that have benefitted from globalisation have naturally embraced it, whereas countries that have suffered from the exploitative nature of globalisation seek to curb it.

Whether a country benefits or suffers from globalisation remains a question of the country's response to it.

Possible opening paragraphs:

- In an age marked by xenophobic agendas, religious extremism and pointing of fingers among international players for the economic problems the world is facing today, the paradigms of globalisation seem to have withered away. Once a promised land of international trust, cooperation and harmony built upon our increased ability to interact and work with people of diverse cultures and nationalities, the 21st century world no longer seems to be able to hold onto this ideal. Instead, unprecedented waves of mass migration and a hyper connectedness facilitated through 'mobile media' and technology have only made more pronounced the jarring differences between us and others.
- Physically, increasing flows of migration have made us neighbours of everyone everywhere. Emotionally, we have had the opportunity to connect through the translation of our corporeal selves into people of a virtual world without geographical identities or cultural inhibitions. Yet the breaking down of geographical barriers has only increased the suspicion and animosity by which we view people from other nationalities who appear different or practise dissimilar customs.
- We should not oppose globalisation, but aspire towards its intrinsic ideals of openness and global solidarity. Only then can we truly say we have arrived at a cosmopolitan 21st century of possibility, boldly going towards a future where



our gaze is naturally more outward than inward, more global than tribal and most importantly, more open and embracing than closed.

- Most worryingly, the world saw a dark shift in mood away from globalisation in 2016. It no longer seems certain we are on an inexorable course towards greater globalisation, stronger multilateral institutions and a more connected world. Instead, we saw nativist politics and protectionist economics growing in strength and influence in Europe and the US. The anti-globalisation trend will undermine international trade, hurting all economies, but particularly small open ones like Singapore, with two-thirds of our gross domestic product (GDP) generated by external demand.
- With a continually shrinking world that accompanies the unyielding progress of globalisation, every society is forced to maximise its productivity in order to remain relevant and competitive in an environment that threatens to leave the weak and incompetent languishing in their dust. Skills viewed to be valuable change rapidly in an economy that constantly seeks to readjust and redefine itself to cope with the brutal and merciless nature of the global market.
- The constant influx of international news inclines us towards caring about these issues especially since responsibility inheres in knowledge. To not act on human rights abuses or stand aloof from international disaster fallouts would be to appear unfeeling, but governments often cite the fundamental problem of scarcity in lending support to international partners. National issues within borders hence take priority because of the limits of fiscal resources, especially as governments need to uphold a social contract with their own citizens.
- Some may argue that scarcity makes it difficult to look beyond national survival and domestic concerns, but the fact that international solutions are the best remedies for these problems simply reinforces the importance of putting international issues first. It is argued that the precise need to survive results in the need for developing countries to involve themselves in



international trade in order to leverage foreign investment to create employment and find resources to further establish their economies.

- Possessing knowledge about international crises through international media outlets and social media channels means we cannot simply stand by with inaction, for otherwise we would be complicit in allowing global problems to perpetuate. Yet, in a globalised milieu (social environment), individuals who withhold information and are as much a part of the global citizenry as their national communities should feel a duty to care for the world and put pressure on governments to do the same. Governments too cannot deny that international issues now have spill-over effects in an increasingly interdependent world since it is undeniable that national security too hinges on international stability.

The importance of a global outlook (and to embrace globalisation)

- In an intensely borderless world where interconnectivity between countries has become a given, having good knowledge of current affairs is often touted as the mark of the enlightened and socially engaged global citizen, and it is a professed goal of many education systems to produce students who are attuned to events that occur in their societies and beyond.

Trans Pacific Partnership (TPP)

- In April 2018, US President Donald Trump asked his trade advisers to look at re-joining the Trans Pacific Partnership (TPP), a multinational trade pact which he withdrew the United States from early 2017 and which he once denounced as a "rape of [USA]".
- Trump's decision to throw out the TPP (which Singapore is part of!) and his pledge to tear up the North American Free Trade Agreement were bedrock promises of his populist campaign, which centred heavily on unfair trade practices that he said had robbed US manufacturers and workers.



- His reconsiderations arised after hearing complaints from important constituents - in this case, Republican lawmakers who said farmers and other businesses in their states would suffer from his trade approach since they send many of their products abroad.

The possible conflict between globalisation and national identity

- When it comes to the relationship between globalization and nationalism, it could be argued that:
 - globalization has diminished nationalism, through increased interdependence and weakening the national barriers between countries. In addition, the compression of time and space allows people to interact more rapidly, thus national differences have disappeared or at least have become less important and noticeable.
 - globalization and nationalism have a mixed relationship in which one leads to the other and one promotes the other. This argument stresses that the system of nation-states was established before globalization, and each state has contributed to the emergence of a global system. However, under globalization, the nation-state is still functioning and promoting the global system.
 - globalization has instead intensified nationalist sentiments. Globalization increases awareness of social heterogeneity because democracy allows people to participate and freedom of speech is guaranteed, so groups whose identity is based on race, ethnicity, religion, language have become increasingly vocal and have used the global media to make their discontent known. Minorities now aim to more effectively assert their identity in reaction to hegemonic cultural forces.



Exposure to volatility

- President Donald Trump announced recently in early May 2018 that he will withdraw the United States from the Iran nuclear deal and restore far-reaching sanctions aimed at severing Iran from the global financial system.
- In fact, he went on to mention that “Any nation that helps Iran in its quest for nuclear weapons could also be strongly sanctioned by the United States.”
- The landmark 2015 nuclear agreement lifted sanctions on Iran that crippled its economy and cut its oil exports roughly in half. In exchange for sanctions relief, Iran accepted limits on its nuclear program and allowed international inspectors into its facilities.
- PROBLEM: Exiting the deal fulfills one of Trump's campaign promises, but threatens to strain U.S. relations with some of its closest allies and disrupt a significant source of the world's oil. It also gives Iran the option of expelling inspectors and resuming nuclear activity that it has agreed to suspend.
- OBVIOUS that Trump's plan to restore sanctions and Europe's resolve to maintain the nuclear deal are directly at odds.

Increased inequality

- Globalization has led to a rise in global income inequality, not a reduction.
- Inequality between individuals across the world is the result of two competing forces: inequality between countries and inequality within countries. For example, strong growth in China and India contributed to significant global income growth, and therefore, decreased inequality between countries. However, inequality within these countries rose sharply. The top 1% income share rose from 7% to 22% in India, and 6% to 14% in China between 1980 and 2016, as reflected in the World Inequality Report 2018.
- Between 1980 and 2016, inequality between the world's citizens increased, despite strong growth in emerging markets. Indeed, the share of global income accrued by the richest 1%, grew from 16% in 1980 to 20% by 2016. Meanwhile the income share of the poorest 50% hovered around 9%. The top



1% – individuals earning more than \$13,500 per month – globally captured twice as much income growth as the bottom 50% of the world population over this period.



Theme 5: Globalisation in Singapore's context

Singapore's small and open economy has made the country largely reliant on foreign trade, and globalization has thus been a catalyzing force for Singapore's rapid economic and societal development.

Singapore's policymakers have largely embraced globalization, and although globalization has brought about numerous benefits to Singapore, it has brought its own share of detriments.

Singapore's Budget 2018

- Although free trade has been unfairly blamed for economic problems around the world, Singapore believes the answer is not to retreat from global competition, said Minister for Foreign Affairs Vivian Balakrishnan
- Singapore's response is to step up economic revamp, skills upgrading, innovation and opening of business doors.
- Finance Minister Heng Swee Kiat sketched out three major shifts in the coming decade, which he said will provide opportunities but also bring new challenges:
 - Firstly, the shift in global economic weight towards Asia has seen China setting up a regional infrastructure bank and laying out bold plans under its Belt and Road initiative, while India is reforming its economy by easing restrictions on foreign investments. Closer to home, countries in the Association of Southeast Asian Nations are also moving up the value chain as their middle-class populations grow rapidly. These developments represent "significant opportunities" for Singapore's firms and people, and its economy must be "geared to ride on and contribute to Asia's growth", said Mr Heng. However, threats such as terrorism, as well as tensions on the Korean peninsula and South China Sea, may dampen investor confidence and adversely impact regional growth and stability.



- Secondly, new technologies are reshaping the economy and jobs. For instance, Mr Heng noted how the rise of e-commerce and a sharing economy have complemented some traditional businesses but also made the environment more competitive for others. Going forward, firms will compete increasingly on intangible assets such as intellectual property, data and user networks. “
- thirdly, the ageing population will result in a significant increase in the Government’s healthcare and social expenditure. Mr Heng noted the possibility that the rapid pace of technological change may also cause older workers to feel marginalised, as there is evidence of “rising discontent” over globalisation and technological disruptions in some advanced economies.

Diversification

- Singapore aims to be a centre for technology-intensive and high value-added manufacturing activities such as chemical engineering, pharmaceuticals and life sciences. The government has also built up its research and development (R&D) capabilities in the form of the Agency for Science, Technology and Research (A*STAR) that has set up several research institutes. One example is the Institute of Molecular and Cell Biology (IMCB) that was established in 1987 to help develop and support biomedical R&D capabilities in Singapore, which has developed a test kit for SARS together with Genelabs Diagnostics. Singapore has also attracted TNCs to establish high value-added manufacturing operations in Singapore, for example, Seagate which is the world's largest manufacturer of hard drives.
- It also aims to become a regional hub for education by attracting leading universities to set up their branches in Singapore. One example is the University of Pennsylvania's Wharton School of Business and Shanghai Jiao Tong University. By attracting prestigious universities to set up regional campuses here, thereby creating a strong university sector that will attract foreign talent.
- It also promotes tourism by building two IRs (in Sentosa and Marina Bay) to compete with tourist attractions in the region.



Regionalisation

- Singapore ventures abroad through regionalisation, which means investing in nearby countries that have abundant land, lower labour cost and newer markets. For example, the government and Singapore-based companies provide capital and expertise to develop industrial parks in other countries, such as the Suzhou Industrial Park in China and the International Tech Park in Bangalore, India. In return, the host countries provide land and labour for Singapore countries. Singapore has also tried expanding into overseas markets. For example, Singtel has investments in more than 20 countries, including Australia, Indonesia and India. It also invests in new markets, such as the Middle East, Africa, Latin America and Central and Eastern Europe.

Economic Globalisation

- Four Asian Tigers: Hong Kong, Singapore, South Korea and Taiwan took advantage of the global shift in assembly and manufacturing away from high-cost Western producers and experienced miraculous economic transformation.
 - The conventional step taken to kick start development in the 1960's was to implement import substitution. This involved protectionist policies such as raising tariffs to reduce the imports of consumer goods and thereby allowing a country's own industries to develop and stabilise. The Asian Tigers, however, decided to embrace globalisation and capitalise on the growing materialistic attitude developing in much of Europe and North America and so pursued an export-driven model of industrialization and development instead and this was achieved by rapidly increasing the production of goods that could be exported to the highly industrialized nations of the world.
- To increase trade, many countries have created free trade agreements with other countries. Under free trade countries agree to remove trade barriers.
- Economic globalization has allowed many corporations based in the West to move factories and jobs to less economically developed countries, a process called outsourcing. The corporation can pay lower wages, because the



standard of living in less developed countries is much lower. Laws protecting the environment and workers' safety are less widespread in developing countries, which also lowers costs for the corporation. Often, this results in lower costs for consumers, too.

Political Globalization

- Because people, money, and computerized information move so easily around the globe, countries are increasingly working together to fight crime. The idea of maintaining international law has also grown. In 2002, the International Criminal Court was established. This court, which handles cases such as war crimes, has a global reach, although not all countries have accepted it.
- Efforts to confront problems such as global climate change must involve many different countries. The 2009 Copenhagen summit is an example, where representatives from 170 countries gathered to discuss climate change. Other international issues include terrorism, drug trafficking, and immigration.
- Since long, efforts have been on to bring the whole world under one government. The League of Nations and the UN have been the efforts in that direction. It is believed that the world under one government will be safer and freer from conflicts: The UN has belied expectations, but a number of regional organisations like European Union, ASEAN, APEC and SAARC. Supranational organisations like the WTO advocate for free trade in goods and services across national boundaries.
 - The member-states remain sovereign, but through their obligations and commitments, they have, to some extent, integrated themselves to the concerned international organisations and groupings.

Cultural Globalisation

- The homogenizing forces are as strong as the heterogenizing forces. In short, in the globally connected world, we might not be as homogenized as we assume to be.



- For instance, the Internet enables the homogenizing force of English as the world's common language. At the same time, it enables the speakers of various small languages to get connected and build common content [like various regional Wikipedia] like never before. Fifty years ago, were there encyclopedias in all the regional languages? No. Most were in English. Now, you have a diverse set of language in Wikipedia that allows knowledge creation in small languages.
- In a globalized world, we tend to see McDonalds and Starbucks everywhere in the world. Globalisation used to be synonymous with big chains making everywhere feel homogenous, killing off the local flavour of a neighbourhood store by store. A McDonald's in the Vatican. A Starbucks in a Japanese ski resort. A Domino's Pizza in Milan.
- But, the same globalization allows for cuisines of various nations to be explored by people across the world. Think of all the quality Thai, Chinese, Indian or Mexican restaurants sprouting across the world over the past twenty years.
- Again, a connected world also allows one to explore different religions and spiritual paths that were previously out of reach due to geography. You could be sitting in Jakarta and exploring Taoism, Shintoism, Hinduism or various African/native American religions. In the past, your choices would have been very limited to what the local spiritual teachers could teach and what the local publishers could print.
- Hipster culture?